

Static GK Test -14

Q1. Who among the following was the youngest instrumentalist to be awarded the Padma Bhushan, the third highest civilian award of India in 2002?

- A) Pandit Ravi Shankar
- B) Ustad Zakir Hussain**
- C) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi
- D) Ustad Bismillah Khan

Solution: 1.(b) Ustad Zakir Hussain (Tabla player). His Awards : Padma Vibhushan (2023); Padma bhusan (2002); Padma Shri (1988); Sangeet Natak Akademi (1991). Other Tabla Players : Anuradha Pal; Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri; Pandit Kumar Bose. Pandit Ravi Shankar (Sitar); Pandit Bhimsen Joshi (Vocalist); Ustad Bismillah Khan (Shehnai).

Q2. National Sports University is situated in _____.

- A) Mizoram
- B) Tripura
- C) Meghalaya
- D) Manipur**

Solution: 14.(d) Manipur. National Sports University: Established in 2018. Other Sports Universities : Netaji Subhas National Institute of Sports (Patiala), Lakshmbai National College of Physical Education (Kerala), and Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University (Chennai).

Q3. Who is the author of the book 'Elephant in the Womb'?

- A) Twinkle Khanna
- B) Konkana Sen Sharma
- C) Kalki Koechlin**
- D) Farhan Akhtar

Solution: 12.(c) Kalki Koechlin. Other famous Books written by Actresses - Twinkle Khanna: “Mrs Funnybones”, “The Legend of Lakshmi Prasad”, “Pyjamas Are Forgiving”, Priyanka Chopra - “Unfinished”, Soha ali khan - “The perils of being moderately famous”, Sonali Bendre - “Modern Gurukul”, Shilpa shetty - “The Diary of domestic Diva”, Gauri Khan - “My life in Design”.

Q4. Who was the author of the famous book "The Economic History of India"?

- A) Dadabhai Naoroji
- B) PC Dutta
- C) RG Bhandarkar
- D) RC Dutt**

Solution: 9.(d) RC Dutt. Romesh Chunder Dutt, an Indian civil servant, economic historian, and translator of Ramayana and Mahabharata, was the president of Indian National Congress in 1899. Other Books: “The Epic Of The Bharatas Mahabharatas”, “The peasantry of Bengal”. Dadabhai Naoroji: “Poverty and Un-British Rule in India”. RG Bhandarkar: “Early History of the Deccan”

Q5. How many Gold medals India won in the Olympics between 1928 and 1980?

- A) 7
- B) 5
- C) 6
- D) 8**

Solution: 13.(d) 8. India has won 10 gold medals at the Olympics. The men’s hockey team itself accounts for eight of them. After Abhinav Bindra (men’s 10m air rifle shooting - Beijing 2008), Neeraj Chopra (men’s javelin throw - Tokyo 2020) is the second individual Olympic champion. India first participated in the Olympics in 1900 in Paris. The first Indian contingent at the Olympics was in 1920.

Q6. With which of the following classical dance forms is Deepika Reddy associated?

- A) Manipuri
- B) Kuchipudi**

- C) Kathak
- D) Sattriya

Solution: 1.(b) Kuchipudi (Classical dance of Andhra Pradesh): Guru Smt. Vijaya Prasad, Shri Vedantam Lakshmi Narayana Sastry, Dr. Vempati Chinna Satyam, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Shobha Naidu, Raja and Radha Reddy, Kaushalya Reddy, Yamini Reddy, Bhavana Reddy, Atisha Pratap Singh, Arunima Kumar. Manipuri (Classical dance of Manipur): Jhaveri sisters, Guru Bipin Singha, Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Nirmala Mehta. Kathak (classical dance of Uttar Pradesh): Pandit Birju Maharaj, Najma Ayashah, Nalini and Kamalini Asthana, Shovana Narayan, Saswati Sen. Sattriya (classical dance of Assam): Guru Jatin Goswami and Sharodi Saikia.

Q7. A ritual bath named "Shahi Snan" is a major event of which of the following festival?

- A) Teej
- B) Holi
- C) Diwali
- D) Kumbh Mela**

Solution: 9.(d) Kumbh Mela. It is celebrated after a cycle of approximately 12 years when Jupiter completes one revolution in its orbit. It is celebrated at four river-bank pilgrimage sites: Prayagraj (Ganges-Yamuna-Sarasvati rivers confluence), Haridwar (Ganges), Nashik (Godavari), and Ujjain (Shipra). At Prayagraj, Ardh kumbh Mela is held every 6 years and Maha Kumbh at every 12 years.

Q8. Who among the following became the first-ever Indian cricket player to play 400 T20s?

- A) Rohit Sharma**
- B) Dinesh Karthik
- C) Virat Kohli
- D) Mahendra Singh Dhoni

Solution: 12.(a) Rohit Sharma {Indian cricket team captain (As of April 2023)}, Virat Kohli - Most runs in T20 international and IPL. Mahendra Singh Dhoni (former Indian Captain) - In his captaincy, India won the 2007 ICC World T20, 2011 ODI Cricket World Cup. Dinesh Karthik is the first-ever Indian cricketer to win a Twenty20 International Man of the Match award. The ODI World Cup 2023 host - India.

Q9. Who among the following personalities is known as the ‘Queen of Carnatic Music’?

- A) MS Subbulakshmi**
- B) Vijaya Rajendran
- C) Kavita Krishnamoorti
- D) Lata Mangeshkar

Solution: 15.(a) MS Subbulakshmi. An Indian Carnatic singer from Tamil Nadu. She was the first musician ever to be awarded the Bharat Ratna (1998). Other Awards: Padma Vibhushan (1975), Padma Bhushan (1954), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1956), Ramon Magsaysay Award (often considered Asia's Nobel Prize) (1974), Kalidas Samman (1988), Indira Gandhi Award for National Integration (1990), Sangeetha Kalanidhi (1968).

Q10. The poet saint Kabir Das was born in sometime in the 15th century.

- A) Kashi**
- B) Amritsar
- C) Somnath
- D) Agra

Solution: 7.(a) Kashi (Uttar Pradesh). Kabir was a 15th century mystic poet, saint of the Bhakti Movement. Books - Bijak, Kabir Parachai, Sakhi Granth, and Kabir Granthawali. His verses are found in Sikhism’s scripture Guru Granth Sahib. Saint Kabir was the contemporary of Guru Nanak and Delhi Sultan Sikandar Lodhi.

Q11. In 2023, which Indian Tennis player became the oldest to win the ATP Masters 1000 title?

- A) Rohan Bopanna**
- B) Mahesh Bhupathi

- C) Vijay Amritraj
D) Ramanathan Krishnan

Solution: 11.(a) Rohan Bopanna. A member of India's Davis Cup team since 2002, he also represented India in the 2012 and 2016 editions of the Olympics. Awards: Arjuna Award for Lawn Tennis (2018), Grand Slam title mixed doubles event at the 2017 French Open. The Association of Tennis Professionals (ATP) Masters 1000, launched in 1990, consists of the top male tennis players at nine ATP Tour tournaments, with the winner earning a 1,000 Pepperstone ATP ranking.

Q12. By which of the following state governments is the Tansen Music Festival organised?

- A) Maharashtra Government
B) Madhya Pradesh Government
C) Rajasthan Government
D) Uttar Pradesh Government

Solution: 3.(b) Madhya Pradesh Government. Tansen Samaroh, an annual event in Behat village, Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, honors the legendary singer Tansen. States and their music festival : Madhya Pradesh - Malwa Utsav, Lokrang Festival, Pachmarhi Utsav, Akhil Bhartiya Kalidas Samaroh. Maharashtra - Banganga, Ellora Ajanta, Elephanta. Rajasthan - Udaipur World Music Festival, Mewar Festival, Jaisalmer Desert Festival. Uttar Pradesh - Taj Mahotsav, Lucknow Mahotsav, Vrindavan Sharadotsav, Sankat Mochan Sangeet Samaroh.

Q13. Which of the following temple is situated in Tamil Nadu?

- A) Shore temple**
B) Kailasa temple
C) Virupaksha temple
D) Jagannatha temple

Solution: 5.(a) The Shore Temple (Dravidian style). It is located in Mahabalipuram (Tamil Nadu). It was designated a UNESCO World Heritage site in 1984. It was built probably in the reign of Narasimhavarman II. The Kailasa or Kailasanatha temple (Ellora Caves, Maharashtra), Virupaksha Temple (Hampi, Karnataka), Jagannatha Temple (Puri, Odisha).

Q14. Ganga Dussehra takes place every year on the _____ day of Shukla Paksha of Jyeshtha month.

- A) 6th
B) 8th
C) 10th
D) 12th

Solution: 13.(c) 10th. Ganga Dussehra (Gangavataran) - Hindu festival, marks the descentance of river Ganga on Earth. Holi: full moon date (Purnima) of Falgun month (Feb-March). Diwali: new moon day or Amavasya of Kartik month (Oct-Nov). Raksha Bandhan: full moon day in the holy month of Shravana.

Q15. Gurucharan Singh received the Padma Shri from the Government of India in 2023 for his contributions to the sport of_____.

- A) football
B) basketball
C) kabaddi
D) cricket

Solution: 8.(d) Cricket. Gurucharan Singh is a cricket coach, the second cricket coach to be awarded the Dronacharya Award (1987) after Desh Prem Azad (awarded in 1986).

Q16. Arvind Parikh is associated with which of the following musical instruments?

- A) Shehnai
B) Mridangam
C) Tabla
D) Sitar

Solution: 9.(d) Sitar. Arvind Parikh: Awards - Padma Bhushan (2018), Sangeet Natak Akademi (2003). Famous Musicians with Instruments: Sitar - Pt Ravi Shankar, Budhaditya Mukherjee. Tabla - Ustad Zakir Hussain, Tanmoy Bose, Swapan Chaudhuri. Mridangam - SV Rajarao, Umalayapuram

Sivaraman, Palghat Mani Iyer. Shehnai - Anant Lal, Bismillah Khan, S. Ballesh, Ali Ahmed Hussain Khan.

Q17. Shri Bismillah khan was a famous player of musical instrument_____.

- A) Tabla
B) Drum
C) Shehnai
D) Veena

Solution: 2.(c) Shehnai. Bismillah Khan Awards: Bharat Ratna (2001), Padma Vibhushan (1980), Padma Bhushan (1968), Padma Shri (1961). Tabla players: Zakir Hussain, Trilok Gurtu, Talvin Singh, Anindo Chatterjee, Rimpa Siva, Tanmoy Bose, Swapan Chaudhuri, Bickram Ghosh, Nayan Ghosh, Alope Dutta. Shehnai Players: Ustad Bismillah Khan, Anant Lal, Ali Ahmed Hussain Khan, Raghunath Prasanna. Veena Players: Meera Krishnan, Asad Ali Khan, Siddhartha Banerjee, Aswathi Thirunal Rama Varma, Vainika Charumathi, Rajhesh Vaidhya. Drum Players: Sivamani, Ranjit Barot.

Q18. Who was/is a successful Indian business tycoon and was the founder of Reliance Industries?

- A) Dhirubhai Ambani**
B) Anant Ambani
C) Mukesh Ambani
D) Akash Ambani

Solution: 2.(a) Dhirubhai Ambani (founded Reliance Industries in 1958, Maharashtra) took Reliance public in 1977. In 2016, he was honoured posthumously with the Padma Vibhushan. Reliance Industries's Chairman and Managing Director - Mukesh D. Ambani.

Q19. Chali, Jhumura and Nadu Bhangi are associated with which Indian classical dance form?

- A) Kathakali
B) Sattriya
C) Manipuri
D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 7.(b) Sattriya (Assam): Gayan-Bhayanar Nach, Kharmanar Nach are also associated with Sattriya dance. There were two dance forms prevalent in Assam before the neo-Vaishnava movement such as Ojapali and Devadasi with many classical elements. Two varieties of Ojapali dances are still prevalent in Assam i.e. Sukananni or Maroi Goa Ojah and Vyah Goa Ojah. Sukananti Ojapali is of Sakti cult and Vyah Goa Oja paali is of Vaishnava cult .

Q20. In which of the following games is one player known as the Wicketkeeper?

- A) Football
B) Basketball
C) Cricket
D) Hockey

Solution: 11.(c) Cricket is a bat-and-ball game played between two teams of eleven players, on a field with a 22-yard (20-meter; 66-foot) pitch at its center. Each end features a wicket, consisting of two bails balanced on three stumps. The wicketkeeper stands behind the wickets, catches missed or edged balls, stumps batsmen outside their crease, and appeals for dismissals. Terms used in Cricket are Maiden Over, Follow-on, Catch, Bowled, Stump Out, Run Out, L.B.W, Hit Wicket.

Q21. Of which of the following states is Jallikattu a famous bull-taming festival ?

- A) Karnataka
B) Kerala
C) Arunachal Pradesh
D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 1.(d) Tamil Nadu. Jallikattu : Part of Pongal celebrations on Mattu Pongal day which occurs annually in January. Some Other Festivals : Natyanjali Dance Festival, Karthigai Deepam, Aadi Perukku. Kerala : Onam Festival, Thrissur Pooram Festival, Vishu. Arunachal Pradesh: Nyokum, Dree

Festival, Boori Boot. Karnataka: Kambala (buffalo race), Hampi, Pattadakal.

Q22. What is Tat Vadya?

- A) Percussion instruments
- B) Stringed instruments**
- C) Solid instruments
- D) Wind instruments

Solution: 11.(b) Stringed instruments. The Tat Vadya is a group of musical instruments in which sound is made by the vibration of a chord or a string. Percussion Instruments - Congo, Bongo, Djembe, Darbukas, Hand Drums and Tongue Drums. Idiophones or Ghana Vadya are solid instruments that do not need any further tuning. Examples - Piccolo, Manjira, Jaltarang, Jhanj and Chimta. Wind instruments - woodwinds, such as the flute, clarinet, oboe, and bassoon, also include brass instruments - horn and trumpet.

Q23. "Living root bridges" is an iconic structure found in which state?

- A) Meghalaya**
- B) West Bengal
- C) Himachal Pradesh
- D) Assam

Solution: 14.(a) Meghalaya. Living root bridges (Jing Kieng Jri) - The aerial bridges, built by weaving and adjusting the roots of the Indian rubber tree. Other Famous root bridges - Riwai Root Bridge and Umshiang Double Decker Bridge. Properties - Elastic, easily combined, grows in rough and rocky soils. Grown by Khasi and Jaintia tribes of Meghalaya.

Q24. Which musical instrument Dr A P J Abdul Kalam, former President of India, used to play ?

- A) Guitar
- B) Sarod
- C) Veena**
- D) Piano

Solution: 4.(c) Veena (Stringed instrument). APJ Abdul Kalam : He served as the 11th president of India and known as the Missile Man of India. His Famous Books : "Wings of Fire" (1999), "Ignited Minds" (2002), "Turning Points" (2012), "Learning How to Fly" (2016), "Enlightened Minds" (2017). Exponents of Veena : Rajhesh Vaidhya, Jayanthi Kumaresh, Veena E. Gayathri, Emani Sankara Sastry.

Q25. Begum Akhtar is associated with which of the following fields?

- A) Writing
- B) Politics
- C) Painting
- D) Ghazal**

Solution: 13.(d) Ghazal. Begum Akhtar (Akhtari Bai Faizabadi) - A renowned Indian singer and actress, known as the Queen of Ghazals, renowned for her exceptional performances in Hindustani classical music. Awards: Padma Bhushan(1975), Padma Shri (1968), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award(1972).

Q26. Sutapa Talukdar is associated with which Indian Classical dance form ?

- A) Kuchipudi
- B) Odissi**
- C) Bharatanatyam
- D) Mohiniyattam

Solution: 8.(b) Odissi. Sutapa Talukdar Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards (2019). Other dancers: Odissi - Raghunath Dutta, Deba Prasad Das, Pankaj Charan Das and Gangadhar Pradhan. Kuchipudi - Radha Reddy And Raja Reddy, Yamini Reddy, Kaushalya Reddy, Bhavana Reddy, Lakshmi Narayn Shastri. Bharatanatyam - Rukmini Devi Arundale, Alarnel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai, T. Bala Saraswati, Shobhana Pillai. Mohiniattam - Gopika Varma, Sunanda Nair, Kanak Rele, K. Kalyanikutty Amma, Bharati Shivaji.

Q27. Indian Academy of Sciences, founded in 1934 by CV Raman, is situated in _____

- A) Mumbai

- B) Hyderabad
- C) Bangalore**
- D) New Delhi

Solution: 7.(c) Bangalore. The Indian Academy of Sciences - Registered as a society in 1934 with the aim of promoting the progress and upholding the cause of science, in both pure and applied branches. C.V. Raman, won the Nobel Prize in Physics (1930) for his work on the scattering of light. India celebrates National Science Day on 28 February of every year to commemorate the discovery of the "Raman effect".

Q28. ---Can't read from the Document---

- A) Aurobindo Ghose
- B) Rudyard Kipling
- C) bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
- D) Rabindranath Tagore**

Solution: 15.(d) Rabindranath Tagore. He was also referred to as 'Gurudev', 'Kabiguru', and 'Biswakabi'. He got Nobel Prize for his work Gitanjali. He was a Bengali poet, novelist, and painter, who was highly influential in introducing Indian culture to the west. He was the first non-European to receive the Nobel Prize.

Q29. Harela is a festival of greenery, peace, prosperity, and environmental conservation, primarily celebrated in which of the following states?

- A) Madhya Pradesh
- B) Haryana
- C) Assam
- D) Uttarakhand**

Solution: 6.(d) Uttarakhand. Harela, meaning "Day of Green," marks the new harvest brought by the rainy season and is celebrated annually during the Shravan month in the Kumaon region. Important Indian Festivals - Uttarakhand : Phool Dei, Olgia/Ghee Sankranti, Bat Savitri, Ganga Dussehra/Dasar, Nanda Devi Rajjaat. Assam : Ambubachi festival, Bihu, Majuli festival. Madhya Pradesh : Khajuraho festival, Lokrang Festival, Bhagoria Haat Festival.

Q30. Where is the World Heritage Site, Konark Sun Temple situated in India?

- A) Rajasthan
- B) Madhya Pradesh
- C) Chhattisgarh
- D) Odisha**

Solution: 14.(d) Odisha. It was declared a world heritage site in 1984. Rajasthan - Keoladeo National Park, Jantar Mantar (Jaipur), Jaipur city; Madhya Pradesh - Khajuraho Group of Monuments, Buddhist Monuments at Sanchi, Rock Shelters of Bhimbetka; First heritage site in india (1983) - Ajanta Caves, Ellora Caves, Agra Fort, and Taj Mahal. UNESCO (United Nation Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) - established, 16 November 1945; Headquarter - Paris, France.

Q31. Which among the following is the official sport of Maharashtra, as of 2022?

- A) Mallakhamb
- B) Kalaripayattu
- C) Sand sculptures
- D) Dahi-Handi**

Solution: 6.(d) Dahi-Handi. It is an entertainment and competitive event celebrated with Hindu festival Krishna Janmashtami (birth of god Krishna). Madhya Pradesh (Mallakhamb), Kerala (Kalaripayattu). Puri Beach (Odisha) – Sudarsan Pattnaik is here where he showcases his sand arts. Mysore Sand Sculpture Museum – It is home to several sand models and was founded by M N Gowri.

Q32. Which of the following pairs of "player - sports" is correct? I. Vicky Ostwal - Cricket II. Anshu Malik - Wrestling

- A) Both I and II**
- B) Only I
- C) Only II
- D) Neither I nor II

Solution: 10.(a) Both I and II. Vicky Ostwal - Cricket (left -arm spinner), He was the part of India's U19 World Cup winning team in 2022 (leading wicket taker) and also selected in the auction of IPL 2022 by Delhi Capitals. Anshu Malik - Wrestling (freestyle wrestler), She won the silver medal in the women's 57 kg event at the 2021 World Wrestling Championships held in Oslo, Norway.

Q33. The famous Rath Yatra, Car Festival is associated with which Lord?

- A) Lord Shiva
- B) Lord Jagannath**
- C) Lord Indra
- D) Lord Brahma

Solution: 15.(b) Lord Jagannath. Rath Yatra - It is Hindu chariot festival celebrated annually, on the bright half of the lunar month of Ashadh (June - July). Jagannath temple - Built by King Anantavarman of the Chodaganga dynasty in the 12th century and recognised by European sailors as the white pagoda in the 19th century.

Q34. Kottakkal Nandakumaran Nair is a Sangeet Natak Akademi 2019 Awardee for his contribution to _____.

- A) Bharatanatyam
- B) Contemporary
- C) Kathakali**
- D) Odissi

Solution: 3.(c) Kathakali (Classical Indian dance of Kerala). Kottakal Nandakumaran Nair - He is famous for his 'Kathi' Veshas and has skill in enacting 'Pacha' and 'Minukku' veshas. Exponents of Kathakali : Kalamandalam Gopi, Guru Raghavan Nair, Kalamandalam Murali, K. Shankaranarayan, Govindan Kutty, K. Vasunni. Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu) - Rukmini Devi, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarinel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai. Odissi (Odisha) - Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh, Gangadhar Pradhan, Madhavi Mudgal.

Q35. Ravi Shankar is famous for which of the following musical instruments ?

- A) Veena
- B) Sitar**
- C) Algoza
- D) Flute

Solution: 6.(b) Sitar. Ravi Shankar Awards and honor: Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Vibhushan (1981), Padma Bhushan (1967), Kalidas Samman (1986), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1962), UNESCO Goodwill Ambassador (1999). Other instruments and players: Sitar - Anoushka Shankar, Annapurna Devi, George Harrison. Veena - Asad Ali Khan, Asit Kumar Banerjee, Jaysri Jeyaraaj. Flute - Hariprasad Chaurasia, Rakesh Chaurasia, Ronu Majumdar. Algoza - Ramnath Choudhary, Ustad Khamisu Khan, Ustad Misri Khan.

Q36. Leo Tolstoy is best known for his_____.

- A) dance
- B) acting
- C) direction
- D) novels**

Solution: 3.(d) novels. Leo Tolstoy (1847–1910) was a Russian writer who is regarded as one of the greatest authors of all time. Gandhiji was greatly influenced by Leo Tolstoy, through his book 'The Kingdom of God is Within You' and his essay on 'Christianity and Patriotism'. His major works include the novels 'War and Peace (1869)', 'Anna Karenina', 'Sevastopol Sketches', 'Resurrection', 'Childhood', 'A confession', 'The Three Questions', 'Hadji Murat', 'Youth', 'Family Happiness', 'Boyhood', 'The Cossacks', 'The Devil', 'Ivan the Fool' etc.

Q37. Mohiniyattam is a dance form of which state ?

- A) West Bengal
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Maharashtra
- D) Kerala**

Solution: 1.(d) Kerala. Other dances - Kathakali, Theyyam, Koodiyattam, Kolkali, Ottamthullal, Thiruvathirakali, Oppana, Kalaripayattu. Dance of

other states : Tamil Nadu - Bharatanatyam, Karakattam, Kavadi Attam, Devarattam, Mayilattam. Maharashtra - Lavani, Koli, Tamasha, Povadas, Dhangari Gaja. West Bengal - Santhali, Brita, Gambhira, Lathi, Chhau.

Q38. Which citizen of the Republic of India was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in the year 2014?

- A) Amartya Sen
- B) C. V. Raman
- C) Kailash Satyarthi**
- D) Rabindranath Tagore

Solution: 4.(c) Kailash Satyarthi. The Nobel Peace Prize 2014 was awarded jointly to Kailash Satyarthi and Malala Yousafzai "for their struggle against the suppression of children and young people and for the right of all children to education". Nobel Prize Winners from India - Rabindranath Tagore (1913, Literature), CV Raman (1930, physics,) Hargobind Khorana (1968, Medicine), Mother Teresa (1979, Peace), Subrahmanyam Chandrasekhar (1983, physics), Amartya Sen (1998, Economics), Venkatraman Ramakrishnan (2009, Chemistry), Abhijit Banerjee (2019, Economics).

Q39. Madhuri Barthwal, a folk singer and Padma Shri 2022 awardee, belongs to which of the following states of India?

- A) Uttarakhand**
- B) Himachal Pradesh
- C) Uttar Pradesh
- D) Maharashtra

Solution: 13.(a) Uttarakhand. Madhuri Barthwal is the first woman to be a music composer in All India Radio. On International Women's Day in 2019, she was awarded the Nari Shakti Puraskar by Ram Nath Kovind. Other folk singers of Uttarakhand: Narendra Singh Negi, Pritam Bhartwan, Basanti Devi Bisht.

Q40. Onam is a state festival of _____ .

- A) Gujarat
- B) Karnataka
- C) Goa
- D) Kerala**

Solution: 10.(d) Kerala. Onam: A harvest festival celebrated to commemorate the arrival of King Mahabali. The festival lasts for ten days. Falls on the 22nd Nakshatra Thiruvonam in the Malayalam calendar month of Chingam, which in the Gregorian calendar overlaps with August-September. Festivals of Indian States: Kerala - Onam, Vishu, Thrissur Pooram, Arattu, and Aranmula Uthrattathi. Karnataka - Makar Sankranti, Hampi festival, Hoysala Mahotsava and Karaga. Goa - Shigmo, Sao Joao festival. Gujarat - Rann Utsav, Uttarayan, Shamlaji Melo, Modhera Dance Festival.

Q41. When was the 1st Asian Kabaddi Championship held?

- A) 1970
- B) 1985
- C) 1980**
- D) 1975

Solution: 5.(c) 1980. The 1st Asian Kabaddi Championship was held in 1980 and included as a demonstration game in the 9th Asian Games in New Delhi in 1982. The 9th Championship took place in the Republic of Korea, where India secured its 8th title. Kabaddi was also included in the South Asian Federation (SAF) Games started in 1984 in Dhaka, Bangladesh.

Q42. What is the full form of RPG?

- A) Report Program Generator**
- B) Random Program Generator
- C) Report Process Generator
- D) Random Process Generator

Solution: 10.(a) Report Program Generator. It is a high-level programming language for business applications, introduced in 1959 for the IBM 140. Some Major High Language - Python, Java, C++, JavaScript and C#.

Q43. Sonal Mansingh is associated with which dance form?

- A) Kuchipudi and Sattriya
- B) Bharatanatyam and Odissi**

- C) Manipuri and kathak
D) Manipuri and Kuchipudi

Solution: 1.(b) Bharatnatyam and Odissi. Sonal Mansingh is a prominent Indian classical dancer. Awards: Padma Bhushan (1992), Padma Vibhushan (2003). 8 classical dance forms in India: Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Sattriya (Assam).

Q44. Godaan is a novel written by Munshi Premchand, published in the year_____.

- A) 2006
B) 1936
C) 1976
D) 1906

Solution: 9.(b)1936. Godaan is a famous Hindi novel by Munshi Premchand. Books - Karmabhoomi (1932), Kafan, Gaban (1931), Poos Ki Raat, Nirmala (1928), Thakur Ka Kuan, Eidgah, Namak Ka Daroga, Sevasadan, Do Bailon Ki Katha, Rangbhoomi, Karmabhoomi, Premashram, Nirmala Balidaan, Boodhi Kaki etc.

Q45. Jagoi and Thabal Chongba are the famous dances of which Indian state?

- A) Uttar Pradesh
B) Odisha
C) Manipur
D) Nagaland

Solution: 10.(c) Manipur. Manipuri classical dance, also known as Manipuri Ras Leela dance. Performed during the 'Lai Haroba' festival in honor of the sylvan deities. The musical instruments used in this art are pung, harmonium, flute. Other Dances: Uttar Pradesh - Nautanki, Raslila, Kajri, Jaita. Odisha - Savari, Ghumara, Painka, Munari. Nagaland - Rangma, Zeliang, Nsuirolians.

Q46. Sitar maestro, Pandit Ravi Shankar was awarded which of the following awards by the Government of India in 1999?

- A) Padma Shri
B) Padma Bhushan
C) Bharat Ratna
D) Padma Vibhushan

Solution: 9.(c) Bharat Ratna. It is the highest civilian award in India, introduced in 1954. Recipients receive a Sanad (certificate) signed by the President and a peepal leaf-shaped medallion. First Recipients: C. Rajagopalachari, S. Radhakrishnan, C. V. Raman. Other Recipients (in 1999) : J.P. Narayan (Posthumous), Amartya Sen, Gopinath Bordoloi (Posthumous).

Q47. With which of the following awards was Kuchipudi dancer V Satyanarayana Sarma honoured ?

- A) Kalidas Samman
B) Kabir Puraskar
C) Padma Shri
D) Moortidevi Award

Solution: 11.(c) Padma Shri (1970). V Satyanarayana Sarma: Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1961). Kalidas Samman (1988). Famous Kuchipudi dancers: Raja and Radha Reddy, Yamini Reddy, Kaushalya Reddy, Bhavana Reddy, Lakshmi Narayan Shastri. Kuchipudi - Classical dance of Andhra Pradesh.

Q48. Dhimsa folk dance is performed by the tribes of :

- A) Solan Valley
B) Araku Valley
C) Ketti Valley
D) Parvati Valley

Solution: 12.(b) Araku Valley. Folk dances (Andhra Pradesh): Gobbi, Dandaria, Veeranatyam, Butta bommalu, Bonalu, Dappu, Dhamal, Mathuri and Bathukamma. Tribal (Adivasi) Dances of India: Santhali Dance - West Bengal, Jharkhand. It is practiced by Santhal tribes. Bamboo Dance - Mizoram. Kalbelia Dance - Rajasthan. Elelakkaradi Dance - Kerala. Bhagoria Dance - Madhya Pradesh. Chhau Dance - West Bengal, Jharkhand and

Odisha. Shad Suk Mynsiem - Meghalaya.

Q49. Market Based Economic Dispatch (MBED) Mechanism is related with which of the following ministry?

- A) Ministry of Power**
B) Ministry of Corporate Affairs
C) Ministry of Finance
D) Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Solution: 11.(a) The Ministry of Power. The Market-Based Economic Dispatch (MBED) mechanism proposes a centralised scheduling of power dispatches, both inter-state and intra-state. The Electricity Act, 2003 - An Act to consolidate the laws relating to generation, transmission, distribution, trading and use of electricity.

Q50. In which year was the International Olympic Committee formed?

- A) 1896
B) 1892
C) 1898
D) 1894

Solution: 10.(d) 1894. International Olympic Committee (IOC) : Established - June 23, 1894. Founders - Pierre de Coubertin and Demetrios Vikelas. Function - Organizes the Winter and Summer Olympics. Headquarters : Lausanne, Switzerland. Status : Granted 'Permanent Observer' status at the United Nations in 2009.

Q51. Which music director is popularly known as 'Pancham'?

- A) Khayyam
B) S D Burman
C) R D Burman
D) Anu Malik

Solution: 2.(c) R D Burman (Son of the famous composer Sachin Dev Burman). He was nicknamed 'Pancham' by the legendary actor Ashok Kumar. He composed his first song : 'Ae Meri Topi Palat Ke Aa', which was used by his father in the movie Funtoosh in 1956.

Q52. Zakir Hussain is associated with which musical Instrument?

- A) Violin
B) Guitar
C) Tabla
D) Shehnai

Solution: 5.(c) Tabla. Ustad Zakir Hussain is an Indian tabla player, composer, percussionist, music producer and film actor. Awards - Padma Shri (1988), Padma Bhushan (2002), Padma Vibhushan (2003), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1990), Kalidas Samman (2006), 51st Grammy Award (2009). Tabla players: Zakir Hussain, Trilok Gurtu, Talvin Singh, Anindo Chatterjee, Rimpa Siva, Tanmoy Bose, Swapan Chaudhuri, Bickram Ghosh, Nayan Ghosh, Aloke Dutta.

Q53. International Day for the preservation of the Ozone layer is observed on.

- A) September 13
B) September 10
C) September 16
D) September 18

Solution: 6.(c) World Ozone Day is observed on 16 September. The ozone layer (found in the stratosphere) is a thin part of Earth's atmosphere that absorbs almost all of the sun's harmful ultraviolet light. Ozone Day 2022 theme is 'Global Cooperation to protect Life on Earth'. 18 September - World Bamboo Day, 21 September - International Day of Peace (UN), 26 September - World Environmental Health Day, 10 September - World Suicide Prevention Day (WSPD).

Q54. Which Spanish football team play their home games at the Bernabeu ?

- A) Real Madrid**
B) Elche
C) Barcelona
D) Athletic Madrid

Solution: 4.(a) Real Madrid (Football club): Founded - 1902, Headquartered - Madrid (Spain). Football cups in India - Kalinga Cup, Rovers Cup, Nehru Cup, Durand Cup, Subroto Cup, Santosh Trophy. In India, the first football game was organized between the 'Calcutta Club of Civilians' and the 'Gentlemen of Barrackpore' in 1854. The first football club of India, 'Calcutta FC', was founded in 1872.

Q55. Which of the following is a traditional dance form of Sri Lanka?

- A) Bihu
- B) Kathak
- C) Kandyan dance**
- D) Bharatanatyam

Solution: 14.(c) Kandyan Dance (Developed during the Kandyan kings' reign) - It is an ancient dance style narrating stories from the Indian epic Ramayana. Other Dances of Sri Lanka: PahathaRata Netum, Sabaragamuwa. Dances and States: Bihu (Assam), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), and Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu).

Q56. Defence Research Development Organisation (DRDO), which is under the Ministry of Defence Government of India, was formed in the year _____.

- A) 1948
- B) 1958**
- C) 1975
- D) 1981

Solution: 2.(b) 1958. Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) : The Research and Development wing of the military's research and development, headquartered in Delhi. Achievements of DRDO : Agni and Prithvi series of missiles, Light combat aircraft (Tejas), Multi-barrel rocket launcher (Pinaka) Mk-I, Pilotless Target Aircraft 'Lakshya-I.

Q57. In which of the following cities of Manipur is the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy located ?

- A) Imphal**
- B) Ukhrul
- C) Chandel
- D) Thoubal

Solution: 2.(a) Imphal. Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy, a unit of the Sangeet Natak Academy in New Delhi, is dedicated to teaching Manipuri dance and music. Established in 1954. Other renowned Dance Institutes : National Institute of Kathak Dance (New Delhi), Nalanda Nritya Kala Mahavidyalaya (Mumbai), Ballet Repertoire Academy of India (Mumbai), Sri Thyagaraja College of Music and Dance (Hyderabad), and Nrityanjali Institute of Performing Arts (Mumbai).

Q58. Kerala is famous for which of the following festivals?

- A) Pongal
- B) Ugadi
- C) Bihu
- D) Onam**

Solution: 5.(d) Onam - It is a 10-day harvest festival in Kerala. Other festivals in Kerala : Vishu Thrissur Pooram, Thiruvathira, Theyyam Festival, Attukal Pongala, Makaravilakku. Pongal (Tamil Nadu), Ugadi (Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, and Telangana), Bihu (Assam).

Q59. Ustad Vilayat Ali Khan is a maestro in _____ .

- A) Tabla
- B) Mridangam
- C) Sitar**
- D) Flute

Solution: 7.(c) Sitar. Indian musicians and their instruments - Sitar : Pt. Ravi Shankar, Shahid Parvez Khan, Budhaditya Mukherjee, Anushka Shankar. Tabla : Zakir Hussain, Allah Rakha, Sabir Khan, Pt. Kishan Maharaj. Mridangam : KV Prasad, SV Rajarao, Umalayapuram Sivaraman. Flute : Hari Prasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh, TR Mahalingam.

Q60. Which state initiated the implementation of the Mid-day Meal scheme in elementary schools?

- A) Tamil Nadu**
- B) Madhya Pradesh
- C) Uttar Pradesh
- D) Karnataka

Solution: 8.(a) Tamil Nadu. Mid-day Meal Scheme : Introduced in 1956 by Tamil Nadu's Chief Minister K. Kamaraj, the scheme aimed to reduce school dropout rates and increase enrollment by providing free meals to students. Government schemes for schools : Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (2001-2002), Institution of Eminence Abhiyan (2017), Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (2009), Padhe Bharat, Badhe Bharat (2014).

Q61. The Garba dance is performed in which state?

- A) Haryana
- B) Kerala
- C) Gujarat**
- D) Punjab

Solution: 15.(c) Gujarat. Garba: Performed during Shardiya Navratri (September-October). Other dances of Gujarat: Garba, Dandiya Ras, Tippani Juriun, Bhavai. Haryana: Jhumar, Phag Dance, Daph, Dhamal, Loor, Gugga, Khor, Gagor. Kerala: Ottam Thulal, Kaikottikali, Tappatikali, Mohiniattam. Punjab: Bhangra, Giddha, Daff, Dhaman, Bhand, Naqual.

Q62. Pandit Ram Narayan is a Hindustani Classical musician who plays_____.

- A) Flute
- B) Harmonium
- C) Sarangi**
- D) Tabla

Solution: 15.(c) Sarangi is a stringed musical instrument introduced by Guru Hargobind Sahib ji in India. Instrument and Instrumentalists - Sarangi (Ustad Sultan Khan, Ustad Binda Khan, Haider Bakhsh, Badal Khan, Ram Narayan), Tabla (Kishan Maharaj, Alla Rakha Khan, Zakir Hussain, Nikhil Ghosh), Sarang (Ghulam Ali Sabir Khan, Suhali Yusuf Khan, Sultan Khan, Ustad Binda Khan), Flute (T. R. Mahalingam, Hari Prasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh), Harmonium (R. K. Bijapure, Tulsidas Borkar, Mehmood Dhaulpuri).

Q63. Match the columns.

- A) A-IV, B-II, C-I, D-III
- B) A-III, B-I, C-IV, D-II
- C) A-II, B-IV, C-III, D-I
- D) A-I, B-II, C-IV, D-III**

Solution: 3.(d). A-I, B-II, C-IV, D-III. Festival : Jharkhand - Sarhul, Rohini, Sohrai, Bhagta Parab. Himachal Pradesh - Mandi Shivratri Fair, Phulaich (Fagli), Kullu Dussehra, Losar. Telangana - Ugadi, Peerla Panduga (Bonalu), Medaram Jatara. Punjab - Baisakhi , Jor Mela, Hola Mohalla, Teeyan,Tikka.

Q64. dance is introverted and restrained compared to most other dances of India - the artist never establishes eye contact with the audience.

- A) Kathakali
- B) Manipuri**
- C) Kuchipudi
- D) Bharatnatyam

Solution: 8.(b) Manipuri. Kathakali (Kerala), It is associated with the storytelling form of this art. Kuchipudi (Andhra pradesh), It is a dance-drama performance art. Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu). It is a solo dance performed only by women, A form of illustrative of Hindu religious themes and spiritual ideas emoted by dancers with excellent footwork and impressive gestures.

Q65. 2ndOctober is observed as _____ .

- A) International Non-Violence Day**
- B) World Social Justice Day
- C) World Wildlife Day
- D) International Education Day

Solution: 5.(a) International Non-Violence Day. Gandhi Jayanti - On 2nd October . Martyrs' Day - On January 30 (death anniversary of Gandhi). Important Days: World Social Justice Day - 20 February. World Wildlife Day - 3 March, World Water Day - 22 March, World Earth Day - 22 April, International Day for Biological Diversity - 22 May, Army Day - 15 January.

UNGA (United Nations General Assembly) - Founded 1945, Headquarter - New York, United States.

Q66. Guru Gopinath National Award 2021 was honoured to whom among the following Kathak dancers?

- A) Durga Lal
- B) Roshan Kumari
- C) Kumudini Lakhia**
- D) Shambhu Maharaj

Solution: 6.(c) Kumudini Lakhia, an Indian Kathak dancer and choreographer. Awards - Padma shri (1987), Padma Bhushan (2010), Kalidas Samman (2002-03), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1982). “Guru Gopinath Desiya Natya Puraskaram” is the highest award conferred by the Government of Kerala for excellence in dance. Durga Lal (Kathak dancer of the Jaipur Gharana), Roshan Kumari (Kathak dancer of the Jaipur Gharana), Shambhu Maharaj (Kathak dancer of the Lucknow Gharana).

Q67. Who among the following is one of the recipients of the Dadasaheb Phalke Awards?

- A) Boman Irani
- B) Dharmendra
- C) Sanjay Dutt
- D) Shashi Kapoor**

Solution: 13.(d) Shashi Kapoor. The Government of India honoured him with the Padma Bhushan in 2011. The first recipient of the Dadasaheb phalke award was actress Devika Rani. Asha Parekh - Honoured with Dadasaheb Phalke Award (2020). Dharmendra - Filmfare Lifetime Achievement Award, Padma Bhushan (2012).

Q68. Who was conferred with the Ashok Chakra for his gallantry in 26/11 Mumbai terrorist attacks?

- A) Mohan Chand Sharma
- B) Hemant Karkare**
- C) R P Diengdoh
- D) Mohit Sharma

Solution: 4.(b) Hemant Karkare was the chief of the Mumbai Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS). He was killed in action during the 2008 Mumbai attacks. In 2009, he was posthumously given the Ashoka Chakra, India's highest peacetime gallantry decoration.

Q69. Nasik is also known as ____ capital of India.

- A) Wine**
- B) Gold
- C) Orange
- D) Cotton

Solution: 3.(a) Wine. Nashik ("Wine Capital of India") holds almost half of the wineries in India. Wine is composed of ethanol (12%). Nashik is situated on the banks of river Godavari. The Godavari starts from Trimbakeshwar, Maharashtra and flows to the Bay of Bengal. It is also known for hosting the Kumbh Mela every 12 years.

Q70. Mohiniyattam is associated with which of the following traditional dance styles?

- A) Samapadam
- B) Tribhanga
- C) Chowk
- D) Lasya style**

Solution: 12.(d) Lasya style. Mohiniyattam : A classical dance form from Kerala known for its graceful, fluid movements, emphasizing expressions and storytelling through delicate, swaying gestures in the Lasya style. Samapadam : A steady, rhythmic movement in Bharatanatyam. Tribhanga : A pose in Odissi dance with three bends (head, waist, and knees). Chowk : A position imitating a square – a very masculine stance with the weight of the body equally balanced.

Q71. Who among the following authors wrote "The Living Mountain"?

- A) Amitav Ghosh**
- B) Nitin Gokhale
- C) Anindya Dutta
- D) Kabir Bedi

Solution: 7.(a) Amitav Ghosh. ‘Manohar Parrikar: “Brilliant Mind, Simple Life” by Nitin Gokhale. “Advantage India: The Story of Indian Tennis” by Anindya Dutta. “Stories I Must Tell: Emotional Life of an Actor” autobiography by Kabir Bedi.

Q72. Which of the following festivals is celebrated as the birth anniversary of Guru Nanak Dev?

- A) Hola Mohalla
- B) Baisakhi
- C) Gurpurab**
- D) Chappar Mela

Solution: 4.(c) Gurpurab. Guru Nanak Jayanti, also known as Gurpurab, celebrates the birth anniversary of the first Sikh Guru, Guru Nanak Dev. This festival occurs on Kartik Poornima, the fifteenth lunar day of the month of Kartik, typically in November on the Gregorian calendar. Hola Mohalla, or Hola, is a three-day Sikh festival that usually takes place in March. Vaisakhi, celebrated on April 13 or sometimes April 14, marks the first day of the month of Vaisakh. Chhappar Mela, a popular Punjabi fair, occurs annually in September in the village of Chhappar in the Ludhiana district of Punjab.

Q73. Lovely Choubey is a famous Indian sportswoman associated with _____ sport.

- A) Table Tennis
- B) Lawn Bowls**
- C) Cricket
- D) Kho-Kho

Solution: 8.(b) Lawn Bowls. Lovely Choubey, Rupa Rani Tirkey, Pinki and Nayanmoni Saikia, win the women’s team gold medal and Indian men's fours team (Sunil Bahadur, Navneet Singh, Chandan Kumar Singh and Dinesh Kumar) silver medal at the Commonwealth Games 2022 in Birmingham, UK .

Q74. Who was the first American male athlete to win the Marathon gold medal in the Olympic Games?

- A) Abebe Bikila
- B) Thomas Hicks**
- C) Frank Shorter
- D) John Hayes

Solution: 12.(b) Thomas Hicks. Abebe Bikila was an Ethiopian marathon runner who was a back-to-back Olympic marathon champion (1960 and 1964). Johnny Hayes is probably best known for winning the controversial marathon race at the London Olympics and is one of only three male American athletes to win the Olympic marathon (1908), the other two being Thomas Hicks (1904) and Frank Shorter (1972).

Q75. The Indian National Science Academy is situated in ____.

- A) New Delhi**
- B) Hyderabad
- C) Allahabad
- D) Bangaluru

Solution: 14.(a) New Delhi. The Indian National Science Academy (formerly known as The National Institute of Sciences of India). Established - January 1935 at Calcutta. Headquarters - Delhi. Aim: Promotion of scientific knowledge. Institutions and Place - The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) - New Delhi; Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) - Bengaluru; Indian Institute of Sciences (IISC) - Bengaluru; Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) - New Delhi; Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC) - Trombay, Mumbai.